NexaWorks - Proposal

RFP NWH-AI-2026-01: Enterprise AI Platform & Implementation
Prepared for Northwind Holdings (fictional) | Submitted 4 October 2026

SYNTHETIC PROPOSAL - fictional supplier created for an academic exercise. Not real company data.

1. Executive Summary

NexaWorks proposes Knowledge Fabric, a retrieval-augmented enterprise AI platform delivered through a structured 16-week programme with built-in change management, six weeks of hypercare and round-the-clock support. Our focus is predictable delivery and sustained adoption, not just a technical go-live.

2. Proposed Architecture

Hybrid vector and keyword retrieval with semantic chunking; every answer cites its sources. The platform is model-agnostic and can be deployed in Northwind's cloud tenant or the NexaWorks private cloud. It has been tested by NexaWorks with up to 2 million documents.

3. Integrations

Connectors for SharePoint, Confluence and ServiceNow, plus SAP via OData services. Single sign-on through Microsoft Entra ID. Retrieval respects source-system permissions.

4. Implementation Approach and Timeline

Phase	Weeks	Milestone and acceptance criteria
Mobilise	1-2	Plan, RACI and risk register signed off by the steering committee
Design	3-5	Architecture and security design approved by Northwind IT
Build	6-11	All four connectors indexed; accuracy test at least 88% on agreed questions
Pilot	12-14	200 pilot users; satisfaction score at least 4/5
Rollout	15-16	Enterprise go-live, followed by 6 weeks of hypercare

A steering committee meets every two weeks and the risk register is reviewed weekly. Forty Northwind champions will be trained to support adoption across business units.

5. Team Structure

Nine people: delivery manager, solution architect, two platform engineers, data engineer, QA engineer, change and training lead, named customer success manager and a dedicated support engineer. Named resources stay on the account through hypercare.

6. Pricing and Commercial Assumptions

Item	Amount (USD)
Platform subscription incl. 24x7 support, per year	240,000
Implementation, fixed fee (milestone payments 20/30/30/20)	205,000

Three-year total (subscription + implementation)	925,000

Assumes up to 4,000 users and 5 million documents. Cloud hosting costs in the Northwind tenant are billed to Northwind.

7. Security and Compliance

- ISO/IEC 27001:2022 certified (fictional certificate NXW-2291).
- SOC 2 Type I completed; SOC 2 Type II audit in progress, expected Q2 2027.
- Encryption at rest and in transit; role-based access control; audit logs retained 13 months.
- Customer data is never used for model training; data residency in India or the EU.
- Aligned to India's DPDP Act 2023 and GDPR.

8. Risks and Mitigations

Risk	Mitigation	Owner
Poor source content quality	Content audit in Design phase	NexaWorks data engineer
Low user adoption	Champion network and training plan	Change lead
Integration access delays	Access checklist issued in week 1	Northwind IT
Answer quality drift	Monthly accuracy report and tuning	Customer success manager

9. Support Arrangements

24x7x365 support is included. P1: 30-minute response, 4-hour resolution target. P2: 2-hour response, next-business-day resolution. 99.9% monthly uptime SLA with service credits, a named customer success manager, quarterly business reviews and monthly answer-quality reports.

10. Experience and References

Founded in 2017, NexaWorks has delivered 16 enterprise knowledge and AI deployments. References: Lakeshore Insurance (3,200 users) and Pinnacle Pharma Distribution. Both references are fictional for this exercise.